

Hyperspectral Imager

Researchers turn an ordinary DSLR camera into a computed tomography image spectrometer
<http://bit.ly/tJKI20>



Retro camera porn

Cameras ranging from the Brownie Reflex from 1940 to Canon EOS 50E from 1995:
<http://bit.ly/tZ2Vlb>

Point-and-shoot cameras test

full HD) against each other so as to help you make sense of what is being offered in the market, we also help you identify your needs and accordingly, get the right camera. Four distinct categories were identified: Compact point and shoot, travel zoom, ultra zoom and high-end point and shoot.

High-end point and shoot

Cameras in this category are comparable in features to their entry level DSLR counterparts. The review units we got for this segment are regular point and shoots, with a compact form factor and smaller sensors as compared to DSLRs, but they come with features such as wide apertures — we are talking f/1.8 and f/2.0 here, more manual control options among other things.

Features and Design

Canon had two cameras, viz. the IXUS 310HS and Powershot S100. The latter replaces the older S95 and is capable of shooting in RAW. The S100 sports a wide aperture of f/2.0 which ensures sharp images even under low light conditions. But the wide aperture reduces to f/5.9 at the telephoto end of the 5x zoom, which is annoying. The sensor size of the S100 is much larger than its other Powershot brethren as well as the IXUS 310HS and it comes in a very sturdy metal-finish body with finger grips on its front portion and a rubber thumb rest on the rear side. The IXUS 310HS is a touchscreen based camera with slightly rounded profile. Navigating the touchscreen gets annoying specially when you want to manually adjust the aperture and shutter settings. Doing them on a

touchscreen is painful, you are much better off with a dedicated button or scroller mechanism. The S100 has a movable metallic ring portion just behind the lens barrel which can be programmed to adjust particular functions. This is a very nifty addition to the camera.

In the video mode, one thing to look out for is the super slow motion setting, which shoots a video at 120 or 240 FPS, but it is played back normally. You can also set the Ring Function button beside the record button on the S100 from any of the 20 functions ranging from servo AF mode, Automatic Focus Lock to Custom WB, etc. As if all these features weren't enough, the S100 also has a GPS receiver and a GPS logger which operates even when the camera is off. Be aware that a functioning GPS sips a lot of battery, specially in areas where it is difficult to get a lock on the satellite.

Nikon P7100 had a really unique design among all the competing cameras with lots of curves on the front and a battery of dials on the top. You will either completely love it or completely hate it — we loved it. Its variangle LCD has a mas-



Canon Powershot S100

sive resolution of 921,000 dots and there are no issues viewing the LCD even in broad daylight. The optical viewfinder comes with a diopter adjustment, but it is quite useless as you get a much better view from the LCD. Apart from the mode dial it has the exposure dial on the right hand end and a shortcut dial for WB, Bracketing, ISO and filters on the left hand side. The camera's adjustment dials are located in the front which can be used with the index finger. Just beside the thumb rest you'll find another dial. So many dials will definitely require a very steep learning curve, but once

you master them, things really get quick.

The other camera from Nikon falling under this segment is the Nikon P300. It houses a backside illuminated CMOS sensor and sports a wide f/1.8 aperture. Just like the Canon S100, it reduces to f/4.9 at the telephoto end. It has a measly 9 focus points as opposed to the P7100's 99 focus points. The P300 has a sturdy build and just like the S100 it has grips on the front portion as well as the thumb rest. As a complete contrast to the P7100, the P300 has very few buttons which makes navigation very easy. The right hand edge has the adjustment dial which works with the d-pad adjustment dial in the Manual mode. AF area includes face priority, face tracking, subject tracking among others.

Olympus XZ-1 was our Zero 1 Award winner last year and we decided to pitch it in this battle as well against the newer cameras. It sports a wide aperture of f/1.8 which is ideal for getting shallow depth of field. With the sensor-shift image stabilization paired with the fast f/1.8 lens, it is easy to take sharp photographs even in



Nikon Coolpix P7100